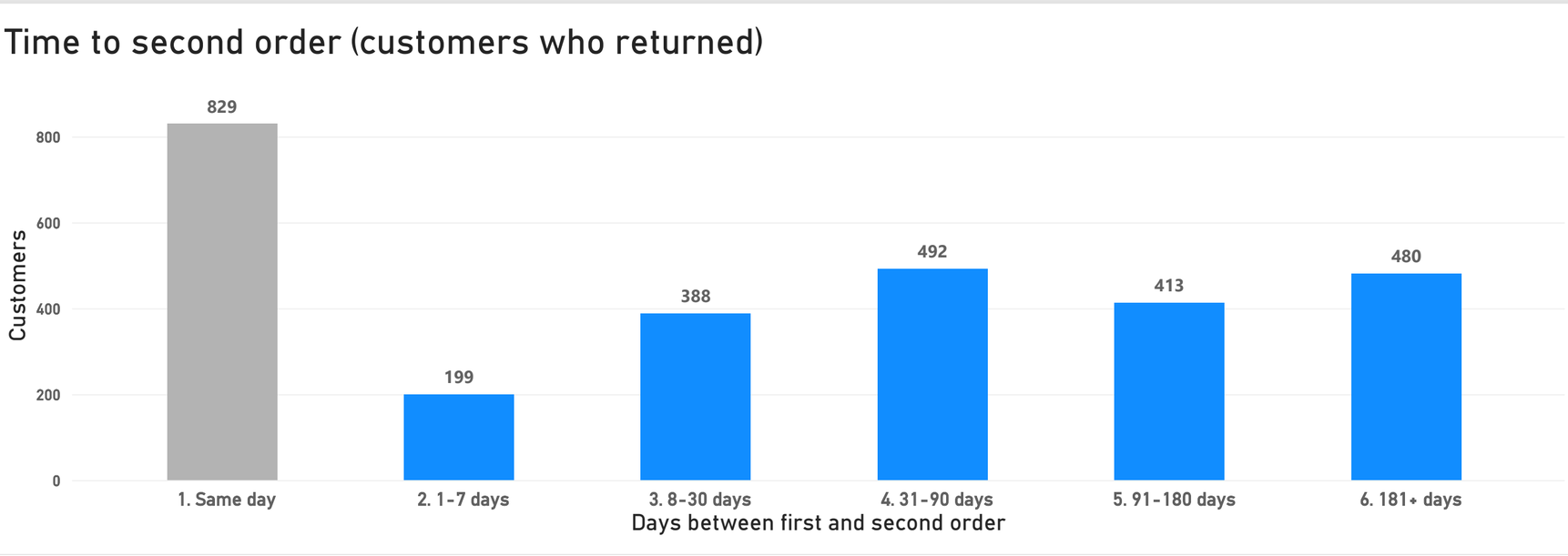
97% of customers buy once and never return

TRUE RETURNER RATE	TOTAL CUSTOMERS	REPEAT RATE	Share of GMV from first orders
2.1%	93,350	3.0%	97.1%

Almost every customer orders only once



Returners are slow, and retention isn’t improving



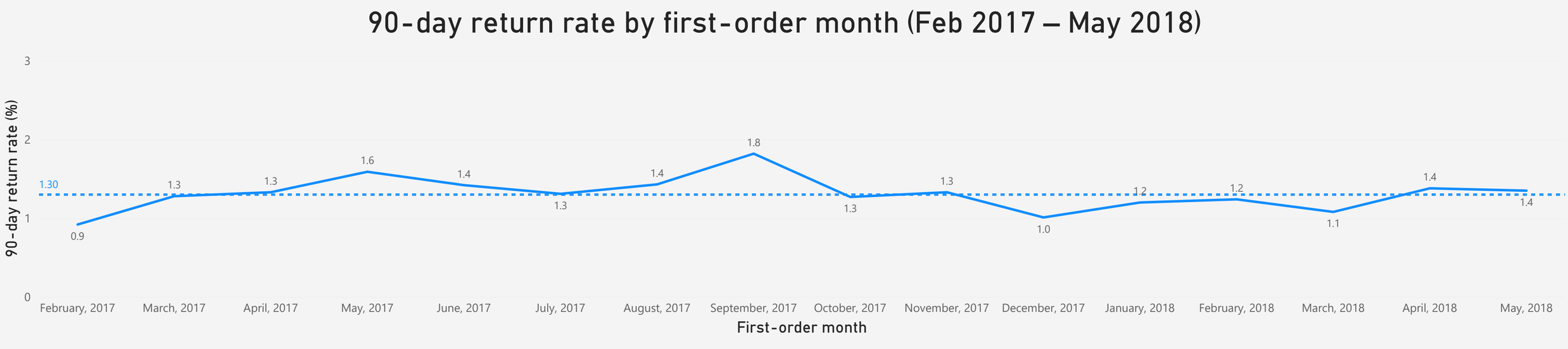
Gaps over 90 days are only visible for earlier cohorts, so the true median is likely longer than 75 days

Median days to a true second order.

75

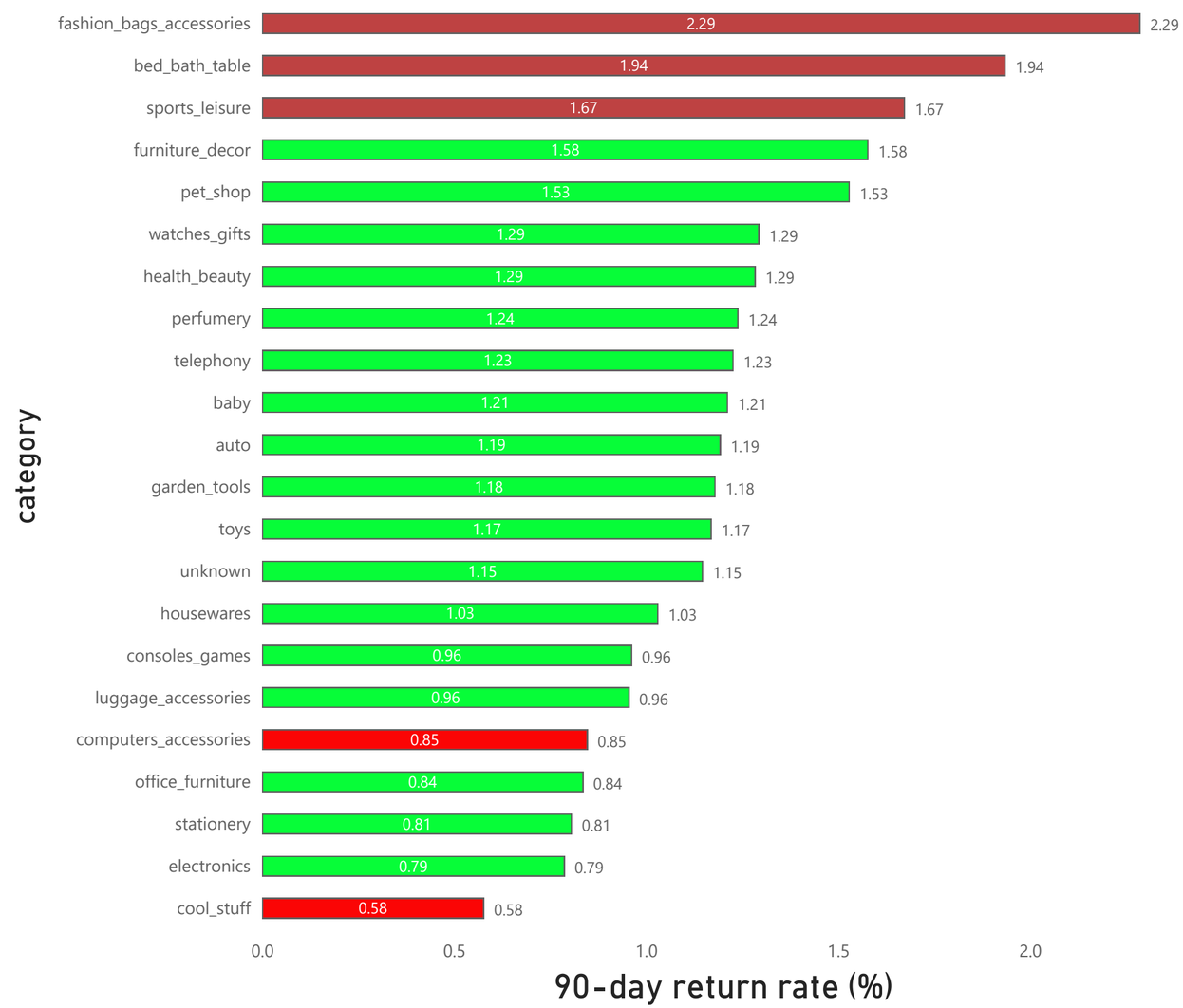
30% of repeat customers ordered again the same day, probably a split cart rather than a real return.

November 2017, the biggest cohort (7,059 customers), returned at only 1.33%.

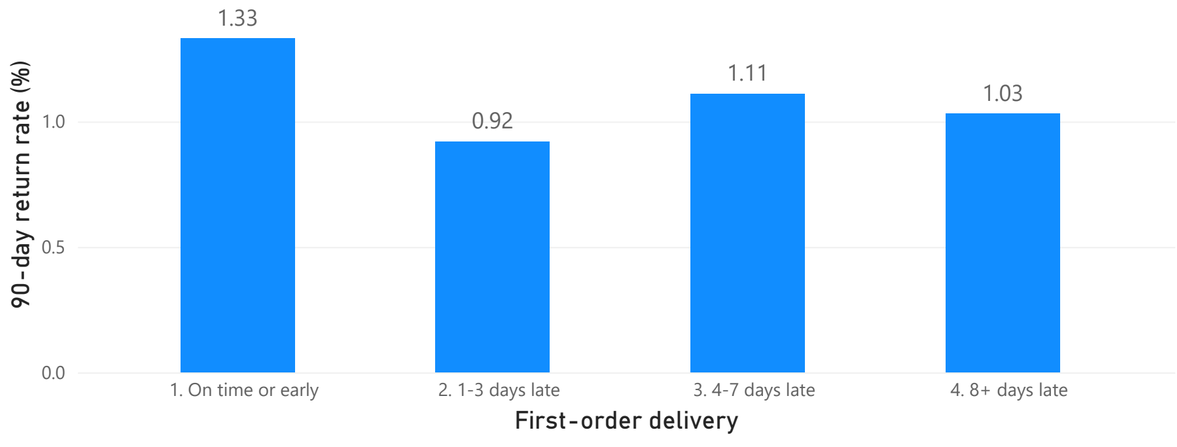


Category matters most; delivery barely does

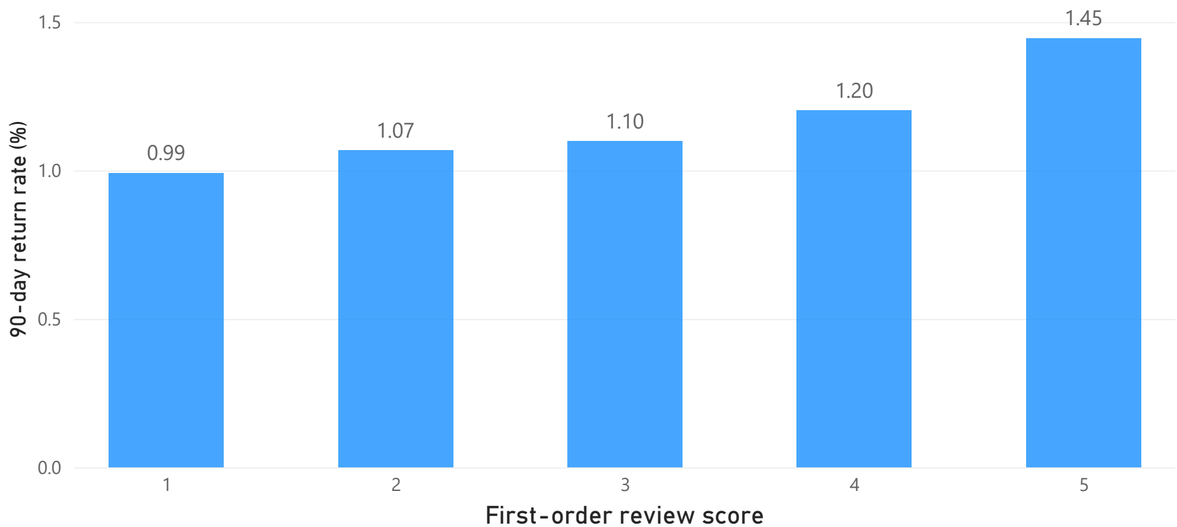
90-day return rate by first-order category.



Delivery performance barely moves return rate



Happier customers return more, but only slightly



Retention is a modest prize: target it, don’t blanket it

Current 90-day return rate (%).	Average repeat order value (R$)
1.30	122.89

What a higher return rate would be worth (lower bound)

Return-rate uplift (points)	Extra returners	Extra GMV (R$)
2.00	1488	182871
1.00	744	91436
0.50	372	45718

Based on 74,404 customers (Feb 2017 – May 2018 cohorts). Counts one extra order per extra returner.

Don’t invest in blanket delivery or loyalty fixes.

Target retention at categories that already retain well (bed bath table, sports leisure, fashion accessories)

Use a low-cost reminder around day 75

- Figures are GMV (item value, excluding freight), not profit. The data has no margin or cost information.
- The scenarios are a lower bound: one extra order per extra returner.
- Findings are associations, not proven causes. Category is based on the most expensive item in the first order.
- Same-day orders aren’t counted as returns. Gaps over 90 days are only visible for earlier cohorts.
- Data is a 2016–2018 Brazilian marketplace (Olist), so results may not transfer to other markets or years.